

As things become more customer-oriented, we have to be able to convert those customer needs into specifications, which is challenging. The future trend is going to be capturing customer requirements, building them into product specifications and making a solution.

What innovative products do you have for the automotive vertical?

We are working on car networking and products that improve safety and security. We are bringing in the capability for communication to happen among cars.

We have rolled out the emergency call concept in Europe, where if you meet with an accident the system automatically sends an alarm to the authorities along with the location data of the vehicle. Within a fraction of a minute, you have help coming to you. Your car would also communicate with other vehicles, which would notify them if traffic is going to slow down.

What markets are you targeting in India?

We focus on the automotive market encompassing both cars and two-wheelers. We have a very strong portfolio in this field. In the identification sector, we have solutions like smart card programmes for government deliveries, healthcare and fare collection services such as the Metro. Then we have standard components. Despite technology advances, we still have the transistor—whether in a chip or

sold discretely. So diodes, transistors, triodes or MOSFETs are in every electronic product. More than two billion units of such tiny devices are used every year in India. The fourth segment is analogue and mixed signal, where we sell micro-controllers, logic devices, RF power devices, etc.

Do you consider India a destination for sales or one that influences marketing decisions?

Unless the ecosystem is developed with some fabs and end-user system manufacturing comes up, things will not change. Now the situation is that the consumers and manufacturers are in different locations. We want to be part of the game and supply products to the end user.

There is currently a huge gap between the demand and supply. It restricts the sense of opportunity for companies in the short run. But in the long run, more design and manufacturing would come to India. In today's context, the work is more of business creation and business development led by marketing. The sales opportunity will evolve.

Right now, the market is small and there is no time to compete. We have to work together. Once we create and expand the pie, everyone will have his strengths and compete anyway. Awareness and educating the people will help more people understand and embrace electronics, creating more demand for the local design and manufacturing. ●

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